



Don't Be Michael

BRAND GUIDE, V2 STUDIO, 2026

Michael finally learned to delegate.

How the Don't Be Michael brand looks, sounds and moves: in the app and on dontbemichael.com. The full system, every token and component, is in `DESIGN.md`. This is the short version.

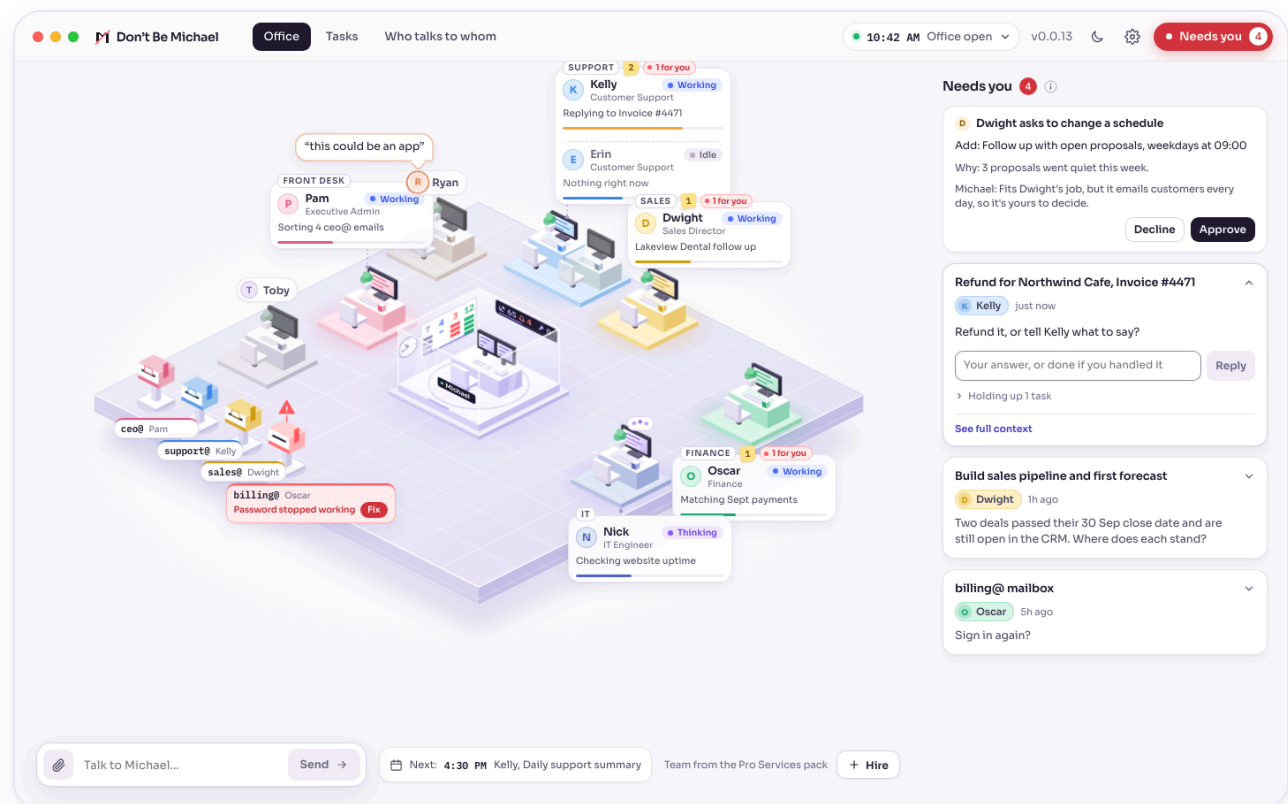
The office Michael should have run.

Michael is the boss who kept every job on his own desk. Don't Be Michael is a team of AI agents that does the work, with Michael as the office manager who finally delegates. The owner stays in control: only what Michael can't settle comes to them.

Every design choice says one of two things. **The work is delegated.** Or **you stay in control.**

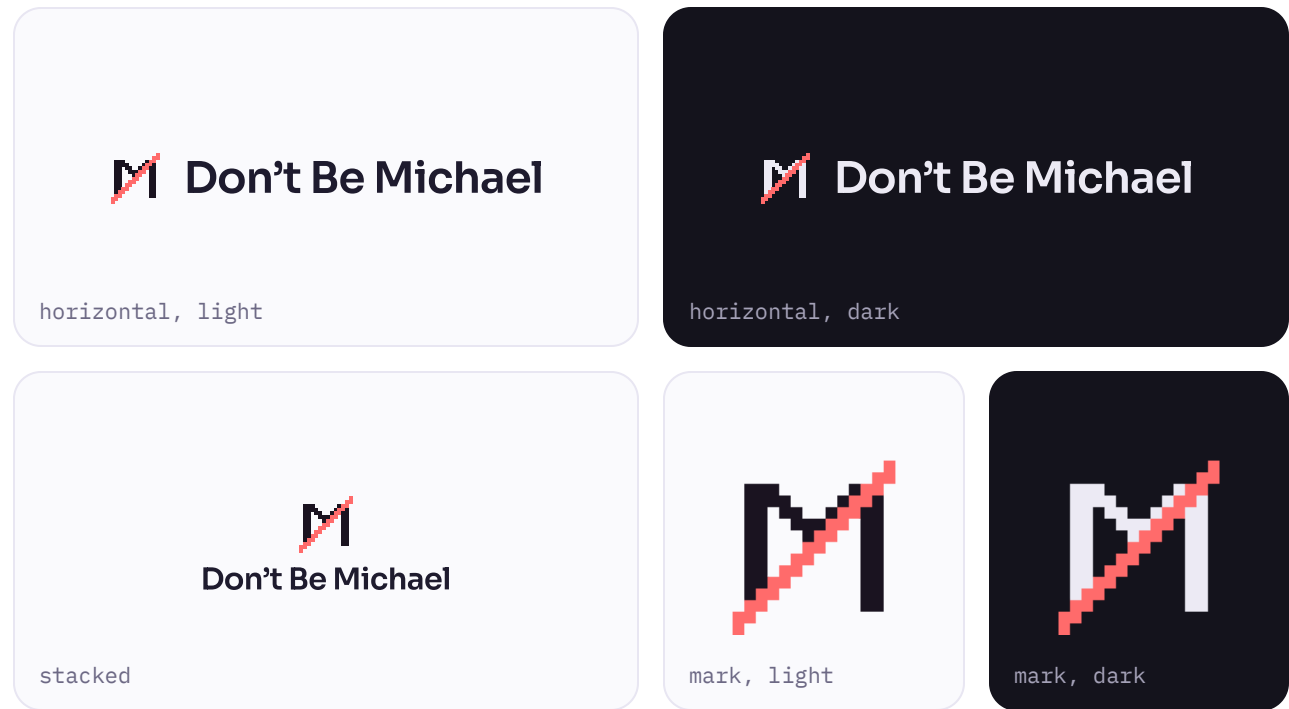
One system, two scales

The app and the website use the same colors, type and illustration. The app is dense; the website is large. There is no louder web palette: coral always means "needs you", green means "done", blue means "working".



The Struck M, and the name in Sora.

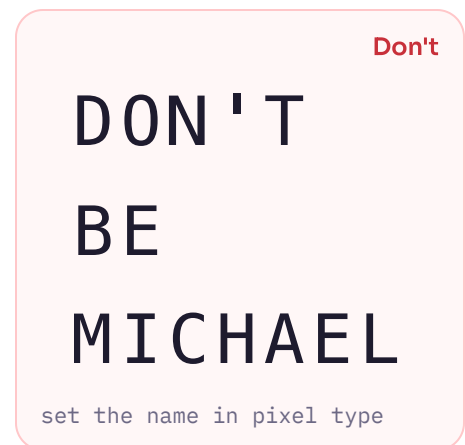
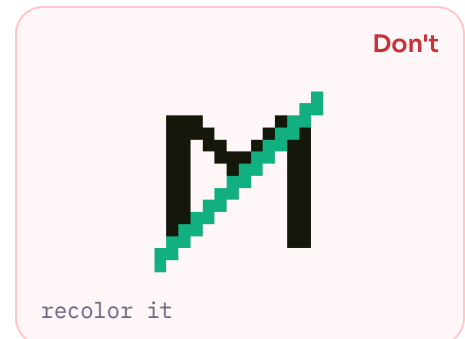
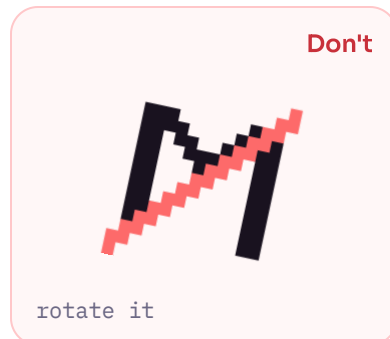
A pixel M with a coral slash: "don't be M". It is the one pixel element in the brand, on purpose. The name is set in Sora SemiBold, sentence case, with the apostrophe.



Rules

- Use the SVG, or a PNG at a multiple of 16 px. Minimum 16 px.
- Keep 2 grid cells (1/8 of the mark) clear on every side.
- The slash is always #FF6B6B. The M is #1A1320 on light, #ECEAF4 on dark.

Leave it alone.



No pixel art anywhere else, no NBC or show logos, no title lettering, no cast photos or likenesses. The team uses *The Office* character names, and that is all it uses.

Calm by default. Coral only for you.

Quiet lavender neutrals, one ink, and six meaning colors. If coral shows up, the owner has something to do.

Neutrals

bg #F7F7FB Grounds	floor #E9E7F7 The studio floor	card #FFFFFF Cards and panels	ink #1E1B2E Text, primary buttons
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Meaning

coral #FF5A5F Needs you. Nothing else.	green #1FB872 Done, on, live	blue #4C6FFF Working	violet #8B5CF6 Thinking, a question
amber #F2A93B Sticky notes, proposals	indigo #6C5CE7 Michael, links, focus		

Departments

Each team member's pod has a pastel family: front desk, support, sales, finance, marketing, people, IT, operations.

front desk #F7C3D2	support #B4D5F8	sales #F8DF95	finance #AEE6CD
marketing #F9C8AE	people #D6C5F4	IT #BAC5E8	operations #A9E3E5

Text colors, soft fills and dark mode values are in `colors/` and `DESIGN.md` section 3. They are measured for contrast; use them rather than the base colors for text.

Sora for words. Plex Mono for numbers.

Sora

All UI and display text, and the wordmark. 400 body, 500 labels, 600 names, titles and buttons.

Refund for Northwind Cafe

Kelly can't issue refunds, and I can't approve money.

`fonts/sora`

Plex Mono

Numbers the owner scans: counts, times, money, ids, email addresses, schedule lines.

38 delegated • 3 to you

support@harborpine.com • 10:42 AM

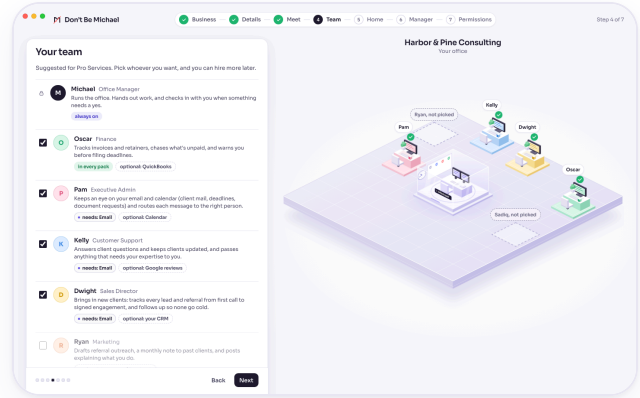
`fonts/ibmplexmono`

The live terminal in the app uses JetBrains Mono. Pixel fonts are retired: nothing in the UI or on the site is set in pixel type.

An office you can watch.

The studio is the app's home screen and the website's hero: an isometric office with one pod per department and Michael's glass pod in the middle. Work arrives at the mailbox posts, goes to Michael, and travels to whoever's job it is. It is a status display, not decoration.

YOU SEE	IT MEANS
A lit screen and a soft glow	● Working
Three dots over the monitor	● Thinking
A coral beacon	● Needs you
A faded pod	● Idle
An envelope, a ?, a check	A request, a question, a finished job
A paper plane leaving Michael's office	He is asking you, on the Needs you board
Lights coming on, or going out	The office opening, or closing time



Every state also has words. Never color or motion alone.

Short, plain, a little dry.

- Name the actor: "Oscar is matching September payments", not "the agent is processing".
- Owner words, not developer words. Fields first; explanations behind an info icon.
- Michael speaks for himself on his cards: "I can't approve money."
- Office humor only where nothing needs doing: idle quotes, empty states. The joke is on Michael, never the customer.
- **No em dashes, no en dashes, no hyphens used as dashes. No emoji in copy.**

DON'T	DO
An error has occurred	Oscar hit a snag
Task blocked on human input	Waiting for you
Permission denied	Oscar needs your OK

The mark on a tile.



A #FFFDF5 tile, a faint ink line, the mark at half size. Favicons use the same ground.

Everything, generated from one script.

FOLDER	FOR
logo/	The mark and the lockups, SVG and PNG, light and dark
app-icon/, web/	App icon and favicons
colors/	colors.css, colors.json, Adobe swatches, a palette sheet
fonts/	Sora, IBM Plex Mono, JetBrains Mono, each with its OFL license
reference/studio/	The approved screens of the app
social/	The 1200 × 630 link preview
DESIGN.md	The full design system: every token, component and rule
source/build.py	Regenerates every asset above

Questions or requests: hello@dontbemichael.com